Bring a medicine list, not a memory test

> Different brands and several appointments can become confusing. An accurate list makes the next review easier.

Check the active ingredient

Different brand names may contain the same medicine. Bring packs or clear photographs when uncertain; do not decide by colour or shape. Ask a pharmacist to check possible duplication.

Record what you actually take

List the name, strength, dose, schedule and reason where known. Include over-the-counter medicines, vitamins, supplements and other remedies. Update the list after changes, especially after hospital discharge.

Describe the reaction

Record what happened, which medicine was involved and when it occurred. Not every side effect is an allergy, but both need reporting. Serious reactions should be clearly documented for future consultations.

A missed dose needs specific advice

Do not automatically double the next dose. Follow the medicine’s instructions or ask a pharmacist. Explain problems with cost, timing or swallowing; a workable plan is more useful than blame. Store medicines safely and do not share prescriptions.

Recognise an emergency

Severe breathing difficulty, swelling of the lips or tongue, collapse or marked illness after medicine needs emergency help. Discuss other adverse effects promptly rather than silently stopping or continuing a troublesome medicine.

For a life-threatening emergency in India, call 112. Elsewhere use your local emergency number.

Questions you may have

Do supplements belong on the list?

Yes. Include every product you use, not just prescribed tablets.

What to remember

A complete current list and clear questions are part of safe treatment.

Sources and further reading

FDA — use medicines wisely
https://www.fda.gov/consumers/womens-health/use-medicines-wisely

FDA — recognising medicine side effects
https://www.fda.gov/drugs/find-information-about-drug/finding-and-learning-about-side-effects-adverse-reactions

NHS — severe allergic reactions
https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/anaphylaxis/

Government of India — Emergency Response Support System 112
https://112.gov.in/about

Educational information supports understanding and does not replace individual medical care. Follow your clinician’s plan. Do not change medicines on your own. Sources checked: 24 October 2026.

Website: https://home-visiting-icu-doctor.vercel.app/#wikiSection
Article: medicines | en